EHD
ELITE HOCKEY DRILLS

FREE 5-DAY PLAN · ADULT PLAYERS · 18+

THE 30-MINUTE HOCKEY POWER PLAN



Three 30-minute sessions a week for adult and beer-league players who train around work, family and late ice times.

HOME · DB · GYM

REBUILD · EXPERIENCED

BUILT AROUND GAME NIGHT

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WELCOME

30 MINUTES. 3 TIMES A WEEK. FASTER ON THE ICE.

Work, family, 10 pm ice times. Most adult players don't have time for a two-hour gym plan — and they don't need one. They need **three focused 30-minute sessions** that train the qualities games actually use: power, single-leg strength, speed and the ability to repeat hard shifts.

This plan gives you one full week: three sessions, a recovery day and a game-day primer, built around when you play.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- 3 × 30-minute sessions: Power + Legs · Speed + Hinge · Shifts + Upper
- Every exercise in 3 versions: home, dumbbells or kettlebell, full gym
- Two starting levels — Rebuild and Experienced
- A 15-min Recovery Flow and a 10-min Game-Day Primer
- Sample weeks for 1-game, weekend and 2-game weeks · tests · a 4-week log

Tap any "▶ Watch demo" button to open the exercise video and full guide on elitehockeydrills.com. Photos in this program are Coach David's own demos.

PICK YOUR LEVEL

NOT EVERYONE STARTS IN THE SAME PLACE.

REBUILD

Who: New to lifting, back after a long break, or coming back from an injury your doctor or physio has cleared.

How: Use the lower number of sets, finish every set feeling 3–4 reps short of failure (RPE 6–7), and use the jump and sprint doses marked "Rebuild" for the first 2 weeks.

EXPERIENCED

Who: You have lifted consistently for 6+ months and know the main movements.

How: Use the higher number of sets, work at RPE 7–8 (2–3 reps left), full jump and sprint doses.

EFFORT: THE RPE SCALE

RPE = how hard a set felt, 1–10. It lets the same plan fit a 25-year-old and a 48-year-old.

6	Easy — 4+ reps left
7	Working — 3 left
8	Hard — 2 left
9	Very hard — 1 left
10	Nothing left (not used here)

YOUR EQUIPMENT

HOME, DUMBBELLS OR GYM — SAME PLAN.

HOME

Bodyweight, a backpack you can load with books, a resistance band, a sturdy table.

DB / KB

A pair of dumbbells or one kettlebell. A bench or a couch.

GYM

Barbell or trap bar, dumbbells, bench, pull-up bar, bike.

Each exercise card lists all three. Pick the one you can do today — you can mix them.

THE 5 DAYS

A	**Power + Legs** · 30 min	hardest day
B	**Speed + Hinge** · 30 min	fast, fresh
C	**Shifts + Upper** · 30 min	conditioning
R	**Recovery Flow** · 15 min	day after a game
P	**Game-Day Primer** · 10 min	before you play

THREE RULES FOR GAME WEEKS

- A and B at least **48 hours** before a game.
- Nothing hard the day before a game.
- The day after a game = Recovery Flow, not a hard session.

FIT IT AROUND YOUR HOCKEY

THREE SAMPLE WEEKS

Move the days around your life. Keep the three rules.

ONE GAME A WEEK (THURSDAY NIGHT)

Mon	B · Speed + Hinge
Tue	C · Shifts + Upper
Wed	Rest
Thu	Primer + GAME
Fri	Recovery Flow
Sat	A · Power + Legs
Sun	Rest

WEEKEND GAME (SUNDAY)

Mon	Recovery Flow
Tue	A · Power + Legs
Wed	Rest
Thu	B · Speed + Hinge
Fri	C · Shifts + Upper
Sat	Rest
Sun	Primer + GAME

TWO GAMES (TUE + SAT)

Mon	Rest
Tue	Primer + GAME
Wed	Recovery Flow
Thu	A · Power + Legs
Fri	Rest
Sat	Primer + GAME
Sun	Recovery Flow

Two-game weeks: one full session is enough. Add C on Monday only if you feel fresh.

CRAZY WEEK?

Only 2 sessions: do **A + C**. Only 1: do **A**. Something is always better than nothing — and nothing is fine when life wins. Pick it back up next week.

BEFORE YOU START

TRAIN HARD. STAY IN THE GAME.

CHECK WITH YOUR DOCTOR FIRST IF...

- you have a heart, blood-pressure or other medical condition,
- you have chest pain, dizziness or unusual breathlessness with exercise,
- you are coming back from surgery or an injury, or have been inactive for a long time.

PAIN RULES

- Hard work, burning muscles, heavy breathing: normal.
- Sharp pain, joint pain, or pain that changes how you move: stop that exercise and use the swap on the card.
- Pain that lasts into the next day or keeps returning: get it checked by a physio or doctor.

OVER 40, OR BACK AFTER A LONG BREAK?

- Start on the Rebuild level for at least 2 weeks.
- Warm up longer — repeat the warm-up circuit twice.
- Sprints at about 85–90% for the first 2 weeks; bike sprints are a great option.
- Use the Copenhagen and jump swaps if a groin or knee complains.

General training guidance, not medical advice.

BEFORE EVERY SESSION

THE 6-MINUTE WARM-UP

One round, in order, no rest. Over 40 or stiff: two rounds.



90/90 Hip Switch ▸ — 5 each side

Sit with both knees bent at 90°, one in front, one to the side. Rotate the knees to switch sides without using your hands if you can.



World's Greatest Stretch ▸ — 3 each side

Long lunge, same-side elbow to the floor, then rotate and reach that arm to the ceiling.



Glute Bridge ▸ — 10

On your back, drive through the heels, hips up into a straight line, 2 s squeeze.



Cossack Squat ▸ — 4 each side

Wide stance, sit into one hip with the other leg straight, heel down. Only as deep as is comfortable.



A-Skip ▸ — 2 × 15 m

Skip with a high knee and a fast, active foot strike under the hip.



Pogo Hops ▸ — 2 × 10

Small, stiff-ankle bounces. Quiet and quick.

SESSION A · 30 MINUTES

POWER + LEGS

YOUR HARDEST SESSION — 48 H OR MORE BEFORE A GAME.

Jump first while you are fresh, then the main leg exercise, then a pull and a short core finisher. A1/A2 means: do one set of each back to back, then rest.

BLOCK	TIME
Warm-up	6 min
A · Power	6 min
B · Strength pair	13 min
C · Core	5 min

	EXERCISE	REBUILD	EXP.
A	Broad Jump — Stick It	3 × 2	4 × 3
B1	Rear-Foot Elevated Split Squat	2 × 8 each leg	3 × 6–8 each leg
B2	Row	2 × 10	3 × 8–10
C	Side Plank	2 × 20 s each side	3 × 30 s each side



A BROAD JUMP — STICK IT

▶ Watch demo

Rebuild 3 × 2 | **Exp.** 4 × 3 | **Rest** 60–90 s

HOME	Broad jump
DB/KB	Broad jump
GYM	Broad jump or box jump onto a knee-high box (step down)

1. Feet hip-width, swing the arms back.
2. Jump forward as far as you can.
3. Land on both feet and freeze for 2 seconds. Walk back. Every rep starts from still.

"Max jump, frozen landing." MAX INTENT, PERFECT LANDINGS

On the ice: Lower-body power — the quality behind your first three strides.

SWAP: Knees or space don't allow it? Squat jumps in place, 4 × 3.



B1 REAR-FOOT ELEVATED SPLIT SQUAT

▶ Watch demo

Rebuild 2 × 8 each leg | **Exp.** 3 × 6–8 each leg

Rest 30 s between legs

HOME	Bodyweight → backpack with books
DB/KB	A dumbbell in each hand
GYM	Dumbbells, or a barbell / Smith machine

1. Back foot laces-down on a bench or couch, front foot a long stride ahead.
2. Lower straight down until the back knee is just above the floor.
3. Drive through the whole front foot to stand.

"Front leg does the work. Back leg is a kickstand." RPE 7–8

On the ice: Single-leg strength in a stride-like position — the leg you push the ice with.

SWAP: Knee-sensitive? Reverse lunge or a box step-up.



B2 ROW

▶ Watch demo

Rebuild 2 × 10 | **Exp.** 3 × 8–10 | **Rest** 60–90 s after B2

HOME	Inverted row under a sturdy table, or a band row
DB/KB	One-arm dumbbell row on a bench
GYM	Chest-supported dumbbell row or cable row

1. Body or torso braced, shoulders down.
2. Pull the elbows back until the hands reach the ribs.
3. Lower under control — 2 seconds.

"Lead with the chest, squeeze the shoulder blades." RPE 7–8

On the ice: Upper-back strength to hold your posture in a hockey stance and in board battles.

SWAP: No table or band? Backpack bent-over row.



C SIDE PLANK

▶ Watch demo

Rebuild 2 × 20 s each side | **Exp.** 3 × 30 s each side

Rest 15 s

HOME	Side plank
DB/KB	Side plank
GYM	Side plank, or a band/cable Pallof press 3 × 10 each side

1. Elbow under the shoulder, feet stacked.
2. Lift the hips so the body is one straight line.
3. Hold and breathe through the nose.

"Long and stacked." STEADY BREATHING

On the ice: Side-core strength that resists getting pushed off the puck.

SWAP: Shoulder issue? Knees-bent side plank.

SESSION B · 30 MINUTES

SPEED + HINGE

48 H OR MORE BEFORE A GAME.

Sprint and bound early, then the hinge and a push. Sprints are short and fully rested — this is speed work, not conditioning.

BLOCK	TIME
Warm-up	6 min
A · Sprints	7 min
B · Lateral bounds	4 min
C · Strength pair	10 min
D · Adductors	3 min

	EXERCISE	REBUILD	EXP.
A	Acceleration Sprint	4 × 10 m at ~90%	6 × 10–15 m, all-out
B	Lateral Bound — Stick It	2 × 3 each side	3 × 4 each side
C1	Single-Leg Romanian Deadlift	2 × 8 each leg	3 × 8 each leg
C2	Push	2 × 8–12	3 × 6–12
D	Copenhagen Plank — Short Lever	2 × 10 s each side	2 × 20 s each side



A ACCELERATION SPRINT

▶ Watch demo

Rebuild 4 × 10 m at ~90% | **Exp.** 6 × 10–15 m, all-out | **Rest** Walk back + 45 s

HOME	Falling start into a sprint (park, field, driveway)
DB/KB	Same
GYM	Same, or 6 × 8 s hard on a bike

1. Stand tall, lean from the ankles until you have to step.
2. Drive the first 3 steps short and powerful, arms pumping.
3. Ease off after the line, walk back, reset.

"The first three steps are the workout." FAST AND RELAXED

On the ice: Acceleration — the off-ice version of winning the race to a loose puck.

SWAP: Hamstring history or 40+ and returning? Stay at ~85–90% for the first 2 weeks, or use bike sprints.



B LATERAL BOUND — STICK IT

▶ Watch demo

Rebuild 2 × 3 each side | **Exp.** 3 × 4 each side | **Rest** 45 s

HOME	Lateral bound
DB/KB	Lateral bound
GYM	Lateral bound

1. Stand on the outside leg.
2. Push sideways and land on the other leg.
3. Hold the landing for 2 seconds, then push back.

"Stick it. Then go." POWERFUL, CONTROLLED

On the ice: Side-to-side power and single-leg control — the push of a skating stride.

SWAP: Smaller hops if the landing isn't quiet.



C1 SINGLE-LEG ROMANIAN DEADLIFT

▶ Watch demo

Rebuild 2 × 8 each leg | **Exp.** 3 × 8 each leg | **Rest** 30 s

HOME	Bodyweight → backpack
DB/KB	One or two dumbbells / a kettlebell
GYM	Trap bar deadlift 4 × 4–6 (RPE 7–8) instead

1. Stand on one leg, soft knee.
2. Hinge at the hip — chest forward, free leg back, body like a T.
3. Stand back up by squeezing the glute.

"Hips square, long line from head to back heel." RPE 7–8

On the ice: Hamstring and glute strength through length — the back half of every stride.

SWAP: Balance limiting you? Kickstand RDL (back toe on the floor).



C2 PUSH

▶ Watch demo

Rebuild 2 × 8–12 | **Exp.** 3 × 6–12 | **Rest** 60–90 s after C2

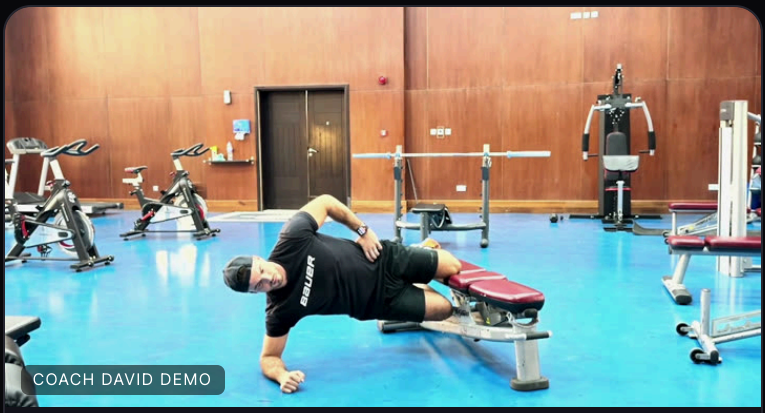
HOME	Push-ups (feet up on a couch to make it harder)
DB/KB	Dumbbell floor press
GYM	Bench press or dumbbell bench press

1. Body or shoulder blades set and braced.
2. Lower under control, elbows at about 45°.
3. Press up powerfully.

"Lower slow, press fast." RPE 7–8

On the ice: Pressing strength for battles and protecting the puck.

SWAP: Shoulder issue? Incline push-ups or a neutral-grip dumbbell press.



D COPENHAGEN PLANK — SHORT LEVER

▶ Watch demo

Rebuild 2 × 10 s each side | **Exp.** 2 × 20 s each side | **Rest** 15 s

HOME	Knee on a couch or chair
DB/KB	Same
GYM	Knee on a bench

1. Side plank with the top knee on a bench, bottom leg free.
2. Lift the hips and press the top knee down into the bench.
3. Hold. Stop if you feel a sharp groin pain.

"Squeeze the bench with the top leg." HARD BUT NO PAIN

On the ice: Strength in the inner-thigh (adductor) muscles that pull your stride back under you.

SWAP: Too hard? Side-lying adductor lifts, 2 × 12 each side.

SESSION C · 30 MINUTES

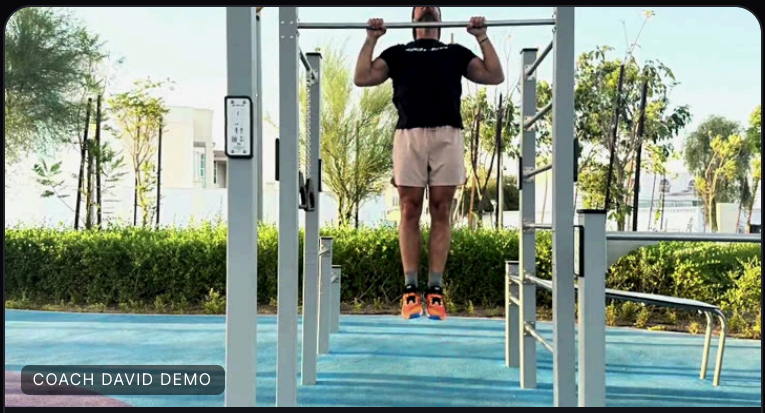
SHIFTS + UPPER

NOT THE DAY BEFORE A GAME.

Upper-body strength first, then conditioning built like a hockey shift: short hard efforts, longer easy recovery. Finish with a carry.

BLOCK	TIME
Warm-up	6 min
A · Upper pair	9 min
B · Shift intervals	12 min
C · Carry	3 min

	EXERCISE	REBUILD	EXP.
A1	Pull-Up	3 × 3–6 (assisted)	3 × 5–8
A2	Half-Kneeling One-Arm Press	2 × 8 each arm	3 × 8 each arm
B	Shift Intervals	5 × 20–30 s hard / 90 s easy	6–8 × 30 s hard / 90 s easy
C	Farmer Carry	2 × 30 m	3 × 40 m



A1 PULL-UP

▶ Watch demo

Rebuild 3 × 3–6 (assisted) | **Exp.** 3 × 5–8 | **Rest** 30 s

HOME	Door-frame bar with a band, or inverted rows under a table
DB/KB	Band-assisted pull-up or inverted row
GYM	Pull-up, band-assisted pull-up or lat pulldown

1. Hang with straight arms, shoulders pulled down.
2. Pull until the chin clears the bar.
3. Lower in 2–3 seconds.

"Elbows to your back pockets." RPE 7–8

On the ice: Pulling strength and shoulder balance for a sport full of pushing and shooting.

SWAP: Can't do one yet? 3 × 5 slow lowering reps (jump up, 4 s down).



A2 HALF-KNEELING ONE-ARM PRESS

▶ Watch demo

Rebuild 2 × 8 each arm | **Exp.** 3 × 8 each arm

Rest 60 s after A2

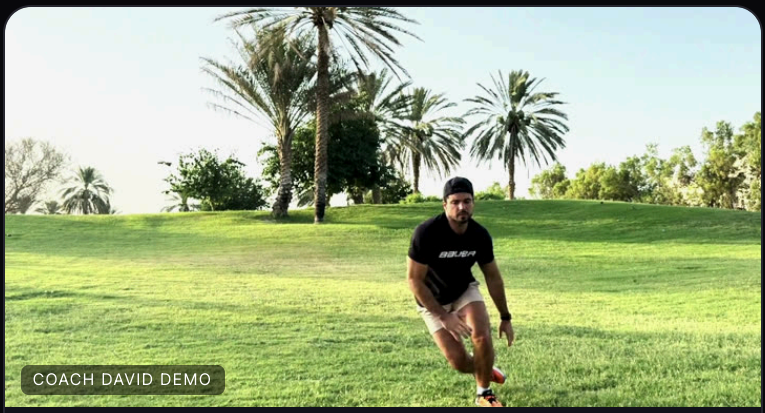
HOME	Backpack or water jug press, or pike push-ups
DB/KB	Dumbbell or kettlebell
GYM	Dumbbell or landmine press

1. Kneel on one knee, the other foot in front, squeeze the glute of the down leg.
2. Press the weight overhead on the side of the down knee.
3. Ribs down — no leaning back.

"Tall and braced." RPE 7–8

On the ice: Overhead strength with a stable trunk.

SWAP: Shoulder pain overhead? Landmine press or a push-up instead.



B SHIFT INTERVALS

▶ Watch demo

Rebuild 5 × 20–30 s hard / 90 s easy

Exp. 6–8 × 30 s hard / 90 s easy **Rest** 90 s easy movement

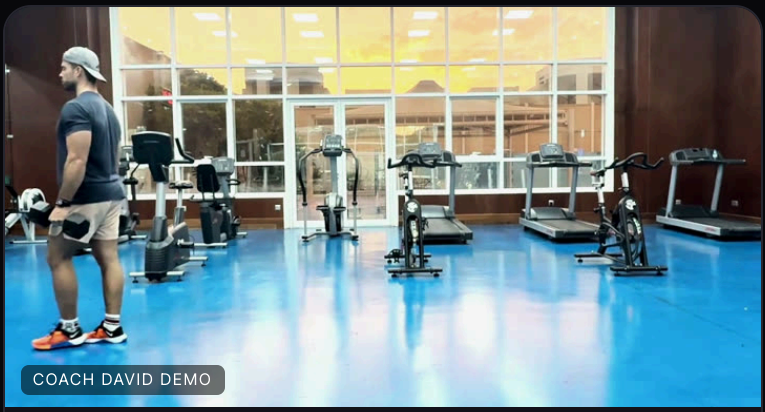
HOME	Skater jumps, shuttle runs (15 m) or stair runs
DB/KB	Same, or kettlebell swings
GYM	Bike, rower or treadmill

1. Work hard for the full interval — like a real shift.
2. Recover easy: walk or pedal lightly, breathe slowly.
3. Your last round should look like your first. If it doesn't, stop there.

"Round 8 looks like round 1." RPE 8–9 ON THE WORK

On the ice: Short hard work with longer recovery is the pattern of a shift. This trains you to repeat it.

SWAP: Joint-friendly: bike or rower.



C FARMER CARRY

▶ How-to guide

Rebuild 2 × 30 m | **Exp.** 3 × 40 m | **Rest** 45 s

HOME	Two full bags, water jugs or a loaded backpack
DB/KB	Heavy dumbbells or kettlebells
GYM	Heavy dumbbells or a trap bar

1. Pick up the weights with a flat back.
2. Walk tall with short, quick steps.
3. Set them down under control.

"Tall spine, crush the handles." HEAVY BUT TALL

On the ice: Grip and trunk strength for stick control and board battles.

SWAP: One side only (suitcase carry) adds anti-tilt core work.

15 MINUTES

RECOVERY FLOW

THE DAY AFTER A GAME OR A HARD SESSION.

Easy movement plus mobility for the hips, groin and upper back. You should feel better at the end than at the start.

Easy walk or bike ▸ — 5 min

Conversation pace, nose breathing.



90/90 Hip Switch ▸ — 2 × 5 each side

Slow and controlled.



Couch Stretch ▸ — 45 s each side

Back knee down, back foot up a wall or couch, squeeze the glute.



Adductor Rocker ▸ — 8 each side

On hands and knees with one leg out to the side, rock the hips back and forward.



T-Spine Rotation ▸ — 6 each side

On all fours, hand behind your head, rotate the elbow up to the ceiling.



Cat-Cow ▸ — 8 slow reps

Round and arch the spine with your breathing.

Got more time? Add 20–40 min easy cardio (walk, bike, swim) at a pace you could hold a conversation at.

10 MINUTES

GAME-DAY PRIMER

AT HOME BEFORE YOU LEAVE, OR BEFORE WARM-UPS AT THE RINK.

Wake the body up without tiring it. Nothing here should feel hard.

Joint circles — 1 min
Ankles, knees, hips, shoulders, neck — 5 slow circles each way.

Glute bridge — 10
2 s squeeze at the top.

Spider lunge + reach — 3 each side
Open the hips and the upper back.

Lateral shuffle — 2 × 10 m each way
Low and quick.

Pogo hops — 2 × 10
Quick, light ankles.

Falling starts — 3 × 5 m at ~80%
Fast feet, not a max effort.

WEEKS 2–4

HOW TO PROGRESS

Repeat the week for **4 weeks**. Same exercises, so you can see real progress. Then retest.

STRENGTH: THE DOUBLE-PROGRESSION RULE

Work inside the rep range. When you hit the top of the range on every set at RPE 8 or easier, add a little load next time (2–5%), or move to the next version (bodyweight → backpack → dumbbells). Then build the reps back up.

JUMPS AND BOUNDS

Add a set only when every landing in the last session was quiet and controlled. Distance first, volume second.

SPRINTS

Rebuild: after 2 good weeks go all-out. Experienced: add distance (10 → 15 → 20 m) before adding reps.

SHIFT INTERVALS

Add one round per week up to 8. When round 8 looks like round 1, shorten the recovery from 90 to 75 seconds.

BAD SLEEP, BIG WORK WEEK, SORE AFTER A GAME?

Use the Rebuild doses that day. Showing up at 70% beats skipping.

THE OTHER HALF

YOU GET FASTER WHEN YOU RECOVER.

SLEEP

Adults should get **7 or more hours** a night on a regular basis (AASM/SRS consensus). After a late game, protect the morning: sleep in if you can, train later.

Watson NF, et al. J Clin Sleep Med. 2015;11(6):591–592.

PROTEIN

Build every meal around protein (meat, fish, eggs, dairy, legumes). A research summary found gains in strength-training adults level off around **1.6 g per kg of body weight per day**.

Morton RW, et al. Br J Sports Med. 2018;52:376–384.

AFTER THE GAME

Water first, then food with protein and carbs. If the post-game beer is part of your team's tradition, enjoy it — just know that alcohol close to bedtime makes sleep worse, and sleep is where recovery happens.

PRINT ME

YOUR TESTS

Do them after the warm-up on Session A day in week 1 and week 4. Same surface, same shoes.

TEST	WEEK 1	WEEK 4
Broad jump Best of 3, measured to the back of the heels.	_____ cm / in	_____
Push-ups One set, perfect form, stop when the form breaks.	_____ reps	_____
Side plank Each side, straight line, stop at 90 s.	_____ s L / R	_____
10 m sprint (from week 2) Falling start, a partner times you on a phone. Best of 3.	_____ s	_____

Body weight (optional): _____ → _____

My #1 goal this season: _____

PRINT ME

4-WEEK LOG

Tick every session. Write your main lift (Session A, B1) as load × reps.

	A	B	C	R	P	A · B1 LOAD×REPS
Wk 1	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_____
Wk 2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_____
Wk 3	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_____
Wk 4	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	_____

WEEK	GAMES	SLEEP (AVG H)	FELT
1	_____	_____	_____
2	_____	_____	_____
3	_____	_____	_____
4	_____	_____	_____

WHAT'S NEXT

A WEEK IS A START. A SEASON IS A PLAN.

After 4 weeks you'll have numbers, habits and a feel for the work. What moves you forward from there is a plan that changes with your season — heavier blocks in the off-season, lighter game-day-aware weeks in-season, new exercises when the old ones stop working.

THE ELITE HOCKEY DRILLS APP

Builds your whole off-ice season around your **age, level, position, schedule and equipment** — every session chosen for you, a demo video for every exercise, lighter around game days, and it rebuilds the week when you miss a day.

First 7 days free, then $17.99/month or $99.90/year. Cancel anytime.

Start the free week →

Prefer one block you own? The 8-week **DOMINATE (19–39)** and **SUSTAIN (40+)** programs are $79 once, with a 30-day money-back guarantee — on elitehockeydrills.com.

Reply to the email this plan came with and tell me your #1 goal for the season. I read every reply.

— Coach David

YOUR COACH



DAVID CIBOCH

- M.Ed. — PE & Sport Science
- Certified Strength & Conditioning Coach
- Former National Team Coach — UAE Ice Hockey
- 1,000+ athletes coached in 30+ countries

I hold a Master's degree in PE & Sport Science and have spent over a decade coaching hockey — from youth development to national-team level, including the UAE National Ice Hockey Team. My training is built on sport science: periodization, force development and hockey-specific movement, with one goal — measurable change on the ice. This plan is built the same way: short sessions, real intent, planned around your next game.

See you on the ice.

ELITE HOCKEY DRILLS

THIRTY MINUTES. EVERY ONE COUNTS.

Questions? Reply to the email this plan came with.
Instagram @elite_hockey_drills · elitehockeydrills.com

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